Ministers also pondered a more drastic step. At a security cabinet meeting in October, Netanyahu proposed revoking the residency of some 80,000 East Jerusalemites who live beyond the concrete-and-barbed wire "separation barrier" that Israel started to build during the Second Intifada. The idea never appeared on a formal cabinet agenda. It was frightening nonetheless to the inhabitants of places like Shuafat, a squalid refugee camp that houses some 30,000 people. Israeli police rarely venture inside, and Palestinian police have no jurisdiction, so crime and drug use are rampant. Netanyahu's proposal would isolate them further—they would lose the ID cards that allow them to cross the barrier for work or pleasure, effectively forcing them to apply for permits to visit an adjacent neighborhood.

One Shuafat resident—19-year-old Mohammed Ali—stabbed an Israeli policeman outside the old city. A CCTV video of the attack showed him sitting calmly on a ledge; one officer appeared to ask for Ali's ID, and the teenager jammed a knife into his neck. He was quickly shot dead.

On a visit a few days later, steps beyond the metal turnstile that led into the camp, there were charred dumpsters and the burned-out hulks of cars, the aftermath of almost daily clashes between Israeli security forces and local youth. Many businesses were shuttered, and the few that were open had hardly any customers. Teenagers peered down from the rooftops, jeering at the soldiers manning the checkpoint into Jerusalem proper. Ali's uncle Mahmoud gestured outside his house, where the streets were littered with trash. "This is all the incitement my nephew needed", he said. "He was angry about the settlers on Al-Aqsa [mosque], but really, it's hard to grow up with any hope here."

The violence would continue intermittently for more than six months. In March, a Palestinian from Qalandia went on a stabbing spree near my home in Jaffa, killing an American tourist and wounding ten others. In June, gunmen attacked a popular market in Tel Aviv, killing four and injuring sixteen. They ordered a leisurely dessert before the shooting spree. There were hundreds of shootings, stabbings and vehicular attacks across the country, far too many to list.

And yet this time the response was oddly subdued. There was no talk of the controversial nation-state law, which Netanyahu had described as so important during the much smaller wave of violence a year earlier. The government did not collapse. A year later, the widest violence in more than